condemned the use of asphyxiating, poisonous or other gases, and of all analogous liquids, materials or devices in war, and agreed that this prohibition should be universally accepted as a part of International Law, binding both the conscience and the practice of nations.

Serious thoughts about disarmament and arms control began after the devastation experienced by humanity in the Second World War. The UN Charter emphasized the need for a regulation of armaments, and thereafter several steps have been taken to effect disarmament and arms control.

Some of the major developments that have taken place in the field of disarmament and arms control since the Second World War are now discussed.

1. ***The Four Power Declaration, 1945:*** The United States of America, Great Britain, the erstwhile Soviet Union and China signed a declaration on 3 October 1945 on general security by which these four powers declared to bring about a practical agreement on regulation of armaments in the post-War period.

2. ***Atomic Energy Commission:*** The United Nations Atomic Energy Commission (UNAEC) was founded on 24 January 1946 by the first resolution of the United Nations General Assembly “to deal with the problems raised by the discovery of atomic energy”.

The Commission comprised one representative from each of those states represented in the Security Council. The Commission was expected to enquire into all phases of the problems of disarmament and make recommendations from time to time and make specific proposals for:

(a) Extending between all nations the exchange of basic scientific informations for peaceful ends.

(b) Control of atomic energy to the extent necessary to ensure its use only for peaceful purposes.

(c) The elimination from national armaments for atomic weapons and of all other weapons adaptable to mass destruction.

(d) Effective safegurads by way of inspection and other means to protect the complying states against the hazards of violations